Laura Elizabeth Moreno-Gama

Contact information: lmorenogama@ucsb.edu

Education

2024 - present	Ph.D student in Political Science, **University of California, Santa Barbara**, Santa Barbara, CA (USA). *Fields*: Comparative Politics, Environmental Politics and Quantitative Methods.
2017-2019	Master of Science in Economics, **Universidad del Rosario**, Bogotá (Colombia). Graduated with honors
2013-2017	Bachelor of Science in Economics, **Universidad del Rosario**. Top 5% best qualified
2016-2017	Exchange Semester, **Universidad Complutense de Madrid** (Spain)

Work and academic experience

Sept 2024 - present — Ph.D student in Political Science at **University of California, Santa Barbara**

- Ph.D. student specializing in the political economy of conflict, development and environmental politics, with a focus on experimental and quasi-experimental methods.
- 2035 Initiative Ph.D. Fellow where I contribute to advancing equitable and effective climate solutions through cutting-edge research and policy analysis.
- Broom Center for Demography Graduate Student Associate, where I contribute to interdisciplinary research on conflict, inequality, environmental change, and the green energy transition in Latin America.
- Graduate Research Assistant responsible for handling datasets, performing statistical analyses. I work with Professor William Nomikos and Professor Matto Mildenberger.

Nov 2025 - present — Catalyst Fellow at the *Berkeley Initiative for Transparency in the Social Sciences* (BITSS) at **University of California, Berkeley**

- Organizer of the ReproducibiliTea Workshop Series, a project that seeks to train graduate students, early-career researchers, and faculty in the principles and practices of open science.

Mar 2023 - Aug 2024 — Nuclear R&D Specialist at **Nawah Energy Company**, Abu Dhabi (United Arab Emirates, UAE)

- Vice-Chair of the Professional Development committee of Women in Nuclear in the UAE. In charge of the R&D chapter.
- Procedures and Records Management Department:
  - Supporting the Control Documents and Records team in the first attempt to automate processes seeking efficiency in plant operations by applying data science tools.

Sept 2020 - Feb 2023 — Research Assistant at **New York University - Abu Dhabi** and **United Arab Emirates University**

Supported research projects related to economic, political, enviornmental and health outcomes funded by the UAE Government.

Jul 2019 - Aug 2020 — Research Assistant at **New York University - Abu Dhabi**

Assisted field projects (Randomized Control Trials) in Congo gathering data and analyzing the impact of different *treatments* (policies) that seek to improve conflict outcomes and in general people's life.

Aug 2017 - Aug 2019	Research Assistant at **Universidad del Rosario** Participated in two large field research projects related to informal jobs in Bogota. Additionally, supported research papers on the political economy of armed conflict and economic development.
Jan-Dec 2017	Consultant at the **Colombian Association of Engineers** Co-lead of a consultancy that sought to understand the challenges faced by young electrical engineers in the Colombian labor market analyzing National Government policies.
Jan-Aug 2017	Intern at the **Colombian National Planning Department** Assisted impact evaluations of the socio-economic impact of health and education public policies in Colombia.

Peer-Reviewed Publications

Do the size of the tourism sector and level of digitalization affect COVID-19 economic policy response? Evidence from developed and developing countries with Usman Khalid (United Arab Emirates University) and Luke Okafor (University of Nottingham)

Research in Progress

- *Green Taxes for Trust: The Limits of Earmarking in Post-Conflict Colombia.*
- *Which Wells Get Shut Down First? Environmental Compliance, Communities, and Oil Decommissioning in the Ecuadorian Amazon*
- *Discounting Tomorrow: Colombia's Renewable Energy Ambitions Amid Conflict and Resource Struggles*, with William Nomikos (UCSB) and Cesar Martinez (UCSB).
- *Political Support for Fossil Fuel Phaseout Policies in Oil-Producing Communities: Evidence from Colombia*, with Cesar Martinez (UCSB).
- *Rebels and the Commons: Armed Group Governance and Common-Pool Resource Management in Colombia*, with Zachariah Parcels (Purdue University).

Honors, Fellowships, and Academic Activities

Jul 2026	Recipient of a summer research support award from the Latin American and Iberian Studies Program, UCSB, to advance dissertation research.
Jun 2026	Participation in the *Institute for Qualitative and Multi-Method Research (IQMR)*, held at Syracuse University.
Jun 2026	Awarded a scholarship to participate in the *Alliance Graduate Summer School: Sustainable Development—From Research Frontiers to Policy Solutions*, hosted by Columbia University in Paris, France.
Nov 2025	Recipient of $4000 from the Berkeley Initiative for Transparency in the Social Sciences (BITSS) to develop: *ReproducibiliTea Workshop Series* at UCSB.
Nov 2025	Participation in the *RIDGE Summer School on the Frontier of Knowledge in Economics*, to be held in Brazil, organized by the Research Institute for Development, Growth and Economics (RIDGE).
Sept 2025	Participation in the *Modern Perspectives on Difference-in-Differences Designs* course organized by ITAM and the LACEA–Impact Evaluation Network.
Jul 2025	Recipient of a summer research support award from the Latin American and Iberian Studies Program, UCSB, to advance dissertation research.
Jun 2025	Recipient of a $2.000 summer research support award from the Political Science Department, UCSB, to advance dissertation research.

May 2025	Participation in the Research Transparency and Reproducibility Training (RT2) at UC Berkeley led by BITSS.
Mar 2025	Awarded the Innovations for Poverty Action's (IPA) Peace and Recovery Initiative exploratory grant for the project "Discounting Tomorrow: Colombia's Renewable Energy Ambitions Amid Conflict and Resource Struggles" $10.000
Sept 2024	Recipient of the Chancellor's Fellowship, awarded to exceptional graduate degree candidates at UCSB. This fellowship will cover all tuition and fees associated with the PhD program for six years.
Oct 2019	Summa cum laude master's thesis (4/4): *More public goods, more violence? The effect of rural roads on armed conflict and illegal economies in Colombia* (Advisors: Juan Fernando Vargas and Jorge Gallego).
Apr 2019	Participation in the Econometric Game at University of Amsterdam.
Jun-Jul 2018	Scholarship for a Summer School in Big Data at *Universidad del Rosario*.
2016-2017	Scholarship to study in Europe (Madrid, Spain).
Jul 2015	Candidate to *colegial* (highest distinction awarded to a student) for being located within the third best qualified in the Economics program at *Universidad del Rosario*.

Teaching experience

Jan-Aug 2019	Teaching Assistant: Economic Measurement at Universidad del Rosario
Jan-Dec 2018	Teaching Assistant: Econometrics I at Universidad del Rosario
Jan 2016 - Jan 2018	Teaching Assistant: Probability and Statistics at Universidad del Rosario

Computer skills

Statistical packages: Stata, R, Python, SurveyCTO, ArcGis, LimeSurvey.
Editing tools: LaTeX, Microsoft Office tools (Word, Excel, etc.)

Additional information

Place | Date of Birth:	Bogotá, Colombia | July 26th, 1995
Place of Residence	Santa Barbara, United States of America
Languages:	Spanish (native), English (fluent), French (working proficiency), Arabic (basic conversational)
Other activities:	Mentor for first-year Political Science Ph.D students at UCSB. Vice President, Graduate Student Association of Political Science and Student Representative, Diversity and Inclusion Committee at UCSB. Co-organizer of the *ReproducibiliTea sessions* at UCSB, in collaboration with Psychology PhD students, to promote good practices in open science among graduate students and faculty.